

- Helpless apathy—Some people believe that their current financial difficulties are simply a result of a run of unfortunate circumstances or bad luck. They believe that things will work out with time and that there is no real cause for their financial difficulty.
- Placing blame—Others are convinced that someone else is responsible for bringing on their financial difficulty. This is rarely the case, but even when the blame for the problem does belong to someone else, the responsibility for resolving it may not be.
- Cinderella syndrome—Because some people are secretly waiting for someone to take them away from their wretched situation, they do not really want to deal with money issues.
- Emotional spending—For emotional spenders, buying is attached to a sense of reward for a job well done or consolidation for having suffered something. To these folks, learning to say “no” feels like punishment.
- Diet mentality—Some people think that once they have resolved their financial difficulties, they will be able to spend all they want. Like the dieters who think they can eat whatever they like after they lose twenty pounds, these budgeters will soon be in trouble again.

Do you ever see life this way? Do you have these attitudes? If so, you may have discovered that your financial situation did not improve, because these ways of dealing with problems are eventually self-defeating. Be on guard to recognize and change any of these attitudes in your life.

Power: You Are What You Drive

Using money to create an illusion of power can prove very tempting. You can control the impression that you allow others

